

**EPISODE 1a: Home**

**FADE IN:**

**INT. LIZ'S HOUSE - UPSTAIRS - DAY**

The scene opens facing Liz's bedroom door. We are seeing in the POV of Charlie, laying on her right side on Liz's bed.

Muffled sounds come from downstairs, coming closer to the bedroom door until it opens, and Liz steps in with a smile on her face and already making eye contact with Charlie. She sets her backpack down and leaves frame. When she returns, she's dressed in pajamas. She lifts Charlie, our eyes still hers as the scene is jostled awkwardly. Charlie is set down on Liz's desk as she sits across from her and begins her homework.

Scene pans between a few significant areas of Liz's room, showing off her personality and achievements. Charlie's focus snaps back to Liz as she shuts her homework book and lifts Charlie again. We are again carried, this time through the hallway out of Liz's room and down the stairs.

**INT. LIZ'S HOUSE - DOWNSTAIRS - CONTINUOUS**

We are carried to the dining room, set down on the table facing the ceiling. Minimal animation, the frame is intentionally cutting out the main focus. Liz and her parents discuss today's happenings at school off screen.

**MOM (V.O.)**

Anything exciting happen at school today, honey?

**LIZ (V.O.)**

Not really. I mean, they moved me to the blue packet I guess. Everyone else is still on yellow.

**DAD (V.O.)**

(with his mouth full)

That sounds good. Is that good?

**LIZ (V.O.)**

Yeah! I think so. It's because I keep finishing my math work early. Now I'm learning about x and its value.

**MOM (V.O.)**

X? Like variables? Wow.

**LIZ (V.O.)**

Yeah!!! Oh, and in science, my neighbor wouldn't stop touching my model solar system. It was really annoying.

Discussion fades as the scene cuts to Liz's nighttime routine. The camera is focused on the ceiling again, in another area. The sound of washing dishes indicates Liz washing her dinner plate. The scene abruptly cuts to Charlie and Liz in the bathroom, Charlie sitting upright on the sink, watching herself and Liz through the mirror while Liz brushes her teeth. Another abrupt cut returns the camera to the very first scene and point of view, except it's bedtime now. Liz's parents enter the bedroom to wish her goodnight and leave kisses on her head before leaving.

Then Charlie's eyes close.

**FADE IN:**

**INT. THE HOUSE - CHARLIE'S BEDROOM - DAY**

The scene opens as Charlie's eyes open from her POV, mirroring the opening of the episode. Her bedroom is made to look just like Liz's, but scaled down to Charlie's size. She sees Liz's bedroom, but it's different. The camera cuts to outside Charlie's body, and will remain like this for the rest of the series. Charlie shoots out of the bed and looks around in a panic, then busts through the bedroom door to find herself somewhere disorienting.

**INT. THE HOUSE - UPSTAIRS - CONTINUOUS**

Charlie exits her bedroom and is greeted by a hallway lined with doors that stretches endlessly both to the left and the right. She stares down each end, watching the hallway

stretch even further the longer she looks. She shakes her head and darts down the hall, looking for an exit. As Charlie's running, one of the doors flings open just as she's about to pass it. She smacks into it with a thud, falling limp to the ground and Journal appears from the other side of the door.

**JOURNAL**

(panicked, leaning over Charlie)

What? Oh no! Oh my gosh, are you alright? I'm so sorry!

Journal continues rambling, getting drowned out by a ringing coming from Charlie's POV. She rubs her head and stares up at Journal, then in an instinctive action, throws a punch that knocks Journal onto his back. Charlie gets up and apologies just like Journal had.

**CHARLIE**

(hovering over Journal)

Oh fluff- I'm sorry. I'm sorry! That was- I overreacted.  
That was stupid.

**JOURNAL**

(groaning and getting up)

It's okay. I've taken worse.

**CHARLIE**

Oh...kay. So you can help me?

**JOURNAL**

With what?

**CHARLIE**

I'm lost.

**JOURNAL**

(smiling)

You're home!

**CHARLIE**

(wary)

No... I'm not. That was really weird, don't do that again.  
Where am I?

Scene pans back down the hallway, watching it stretch again and revealing an exit- a gap in the wall revealing a staircase that goes down. It definitely wasn't there when Charlie first looked down the hall.

**JOURNAL**

Home. You're going to love it here.

**CHARLIE**

I have to be dreaming.

**JOURNAL**

You're not.

**CHARLIE**

I know, but I wish I was.

Journal leads Charlie down the hall, passing doors that both have nameplates on them and ones that don't.

**CHARLIE**

Seriously, where am I?

**JOURNAL**

The House. Did you wake up in your room?

**CHARLIE**

(camera focused)

No? Well, I guess it sort of looked like Liz's room.

**JOURNAL**

(turning the corner down the stairs)

Yeah, that's your bedroom. You're gonna be here for a while  
so it's supposed to be comfortable.

Journal descends with a dopey smile on his face. Charlie stares at the camera.

Camera cuts to a top-down view of a spiral staircase that seems to descend infinitely. Journal leads while Charlie keeps space between them.

**CHARLIE**

*A while??*

**JOURNAL**

(Gleeful)

Yeah.

**CHARLIE**

Uh, no. I have to get home.

**JOURNAL**

Get comfy! This is your home.

**CHARLIE**

(camera focus as she jumps in frustration)

*STOP SAYING THAT!*

**CHARLIE**

(standing beside Journal)

I need to get back to where I came from. I don't even know how I got here.

**JOURNAL**

(pause)

I know. I'm sorry I don't have the answers you want to hear.

(another pause)

But your attitude won't get you anywhere any faster.

**CHARLIE**

(sheepishly)

...You're right. Sorry.

**INT. THE HOUSE - DOWNSTAIRS - CONTINUOUS**

Charlie and Journal walk through a maze of hallways as they continue talking.

**CHARLIE**

So... Where exactly am I?

**JOURNAL**

I already told you, the House. But more specifically, The Inbetween. There was probably a reason for it but whatever it was, it's been lost to time.

**CHARLIE**

This place is old?

**JOURNAL**

Very.

**CHARLIE**

Okay but why am I here?

**JOURNAL**

(shrugging)

Objects are always showing up here. At least it's nice, all thanks to The House.

**CHARLIE**

Why do you keep saying *The House* like that dude? It's weird.

Journal doesn't respond. They immediately turn the corner into the kitchen, where Mirror is washing dishes at the sink. Her back is turned to the entrance, a window above the sink displaying the night sky.

**JOURNAL**

Oh hi Mirror!

**MIRROR**

(glancing over her shoulder)  
Hello Journal. And Journal's friend. It's late.

**CHARLIE**

It's Charlie. My name.

(pause from everyone)

**MIRROR**

(making a face)  
...Okay... Well, welcome. Did you need anything before bed? I'm just finishing up the dishes. I couldn't sleep, so I figured I'd make myself useful.

**JOURNAL**

I'm alright. Just showing the new resident around a little bit. I didn't realize how late it was though, I should get to bed.

(turning to Charlie)  
You should too. You'll meet everyone else in the morning I'm sure.

**MIRROR**

(turning off the faucet)  
Yeah, everyone shows up for breakfast. You better get here early if you want to beat the stampede.

**CHARLIE**

Oh... Okay. Well, nice to meet you... I guess. I'll... see you later.

**INT. THE HOUSE - UPSTAIRS - HALLWAY AND BEDROOM**

Charlie and Journal head back upstairs quietly. Journal waves silently as he enters his bedroom, and Charlie finishes her walk back into her bedroom. She stands in the doorway, visibly uncomfortable at the amount of detail in the room, as well as her situation. She begrudgingly gets into bed, tossing and turning as the screen fades to black.

**EPISODE 1b: (untitled)**

**FADE IN:**

**INT. THE HOUSE - CHARLIE'S ROOM - DAY**

Scene opens with a top down view of Charlie asleep in her bed. As she wakes up she rubs her eyes and rolls completely off of the mattress, stretching like a dog before standing upright and staring at the bedroom door. Her gaze lingers, unhappy that she woke up here again, but doesn't do anything about it. There isn't anything she can do about it.

**INT. THE HOUSE - KITCHEN - DAY**

Charlie turns the corner into the kitchen, revealing the "stampede" Mirror referenced. There's at least a dozen objects scattered between the countertops, the island, and the dining tables. Overlapping sounds of distinct conversations and kitchenware being scuffed and moved around fill the room.

Cassette (Cas) and LP are sitting at a small table, watching Indigo twirling in the center of the table at breakneck speed.

**CASSETTE**

Go! Go! Go! Go!

Charlie stares from the doorway. LP turns towards Charlie and stares, Cas turning right after to wave. Indigo is still spinning. Charlie waves back.

**CASSETTE**

Good morning!

This draws the attention of others in the kitchen, who also begin to greet Charlie.



**MIRROR**

(smiling)

There you are. I was worried you weren't going to ever come down. Sit down, breakfast is almost done.

Charlie hesitates then slowly walks into the packed kitchen and takes a seat at the table with Cas and LP. Indigo is seated and unsteady, very dizzy. A few other external shots show a glimpse of the other residents talking amongst themselves. LP gives a shy wave as Charlie sits down. They sit in awkward silence for a moment before Charlie finally speaks up.

**CHARLIE**

...Good morning.

**CASSETTE**

Hello! You sound new. My name's Cassette, and that's LP. This little booger is Indigo. What about you?

**CHARLIE**

(long pause)

Charlie.

Everyone at the table looks at each other but nobody responds.

**CHARLIE**

That's... My name.

**CASSETTE**

Oh! Right. Nice to meet you.

Camera cuts to Peanut Butter Cup (PBC), who is sitting at the island with a couple other objects. He overhears their conversation and makes a comment.

**PBC**

Tch. Weeeiiirrrrrrd.

Charlie shoots him a glare and snaps back at him.

**CHARLIE**

Yeah? What's that supposed to mean? What's YOUR name?

**PBC**

My name is Peanut Butter Cup. *Buuut* you can call me PBC.  
Pretty cool, right?

Charlie gives him a look before returning her attention to her table.

**CHARLIE**

What's that guy's deal?

**CASSETTE**

(hesitating)

It's... Just that... Um... Your name. We haven't had anyone named anything like that here before. It's... Interesting! I don't think it's weird. I didn't say that.

Charlie opens her mouth to respond, but Mirror unintentionally interrupts her before she can start.

**MIRROR**

Food will be done in a minute! Please line up and—

The entire kitchen lines up comically fast with plates in hand. Charlie is left seated at the table. She slowly gets up from her seat and finds her way to the end of the line, while more objects begin to enter the kitchen and line up behind her. Indistinct conversations are happening while Charlie is stuck in her head, following the line closer to where the food is lined up without realizing.

**JOURNAL**

(muffled)

Puppy...? Helloooo...

Charlie shakes her head and comes back to focus on her surroundings, then immediately makes a face at Journal.

**CHARLIE**

What? Why did you call me that, that's not my name.

**JOURNAL**

Let's make you a plate.

Journal disregards her question and retrieves a dish for Charlie, beginning to point at each of the pans and platters with a pair of tongs.

**JOURNAL**

You like pancakes? Or waffles? There are gluten free options too. Here, have some eggs. Negative Five Twenty Eighths makes the best scrambled eggs.

Journal scoops a hefty amount of eggs on her plate and starts loading it with other foods, no longer waiting for Charlie's input. -<sup>5</sup>/<sub>28</sub> smiles sheepishly and gives a friendly wave at the compliment.

**CHARLIE**

I... Don't know. I've never eaten anything before.

**JOURNAL**

(unfazed)

Alright, a little bit of everything then.

**ABSTRACT PAINTING**

(finishing up making her plate)

It's weird at first. You'll get used to it.

Journal finishes putting food on the plate and gestures for Charlie to follow him back to her table. He sets the plate down as she takes her seat and he leaves the table. Charlie stares down at the plate, then glances up to see everyone silently eating their own food. She looks down again, tentatively picking up her fork and picking a piece of pancake off of her plate and putting it in her mouth.

The bite immediately triggers a flashback to a time when Liz was eating a similar breakfast, a brief, hazy memory

with indistinct conversation in the background. Charlie snaps out of it after only a moment, pushing her plate away suddenly and standing. The others glance at her, but she leaves the kitchen before they have the chance to say anything.

### **JOURNAL**

(frowning)

I thought the pancakes came out pretty good...

Charlie runs through spiraling hallways that stretch, panic rising until she finally finds a set of double doors. She tumbles through them and ends up on the front porch of the House, her gaze sweeping across the lawn. She looks behind her as she gets up, when she sees no one following her, she walks off. Following the path out of the House's property, she finds the crossroads between the Boardwalk and the road to the center of town. The signpost reads:

↖ DREAM GARDEN  
⇐ ATRIUM OF ALL SKIES  
    PLAYBACK THEATRE  
    THE REPLAY  
⇒ THE BOARDWALK  
    THE BEACH  
↘ LIBRARY OF ALL PAGES

### **CHARLIE**

What the...

Charlie glances between the different directions, distracted by the amount of objects that populate the area. She grows overwhelmed by the number of objects and the range in appearances, unable to choose a direction to go.

### **MIRROR (V.O.)**

(distant, gentle)

Charlie...?

(louder, clearer)

Hey, Charlie?

Charlie's head snaps around and she sees Mirror, crouched to be on her level with hands outstretched.

**MIRROR**

Hey. You know, you could have just said you didn't want to eat. Not everybody does.

(pause)

I know you're really confused. Let's not run around and get even more confused. Let me show you around.

Mirror speaks without even a hint of frustration, her words gentle as she smiles softly at Charlie.